

TECHNICAL REPORT: SPC & PROCESS CAPABILITY (Cp & Cpk)

Day-4 Quality Engineering Challenge — 5-Axis CNC Blade Grinding

Component Name: High Pressure Gas Turbine Blade

Parameter Checked: Blade Root Thickness

Target Industry: Aerospace Manufacturing

Material: Inconel 718 (Superalloy)

Lead Inspector: Jagriti Singh (Quality Engineer)

Target Specification: USL = 12.515 mm | LSL = 12.485 mm

1. Document Details & Objective

Target Industry & Application: Aerospace Industry (Precision Superalloy Component Machining).

Objectives of the Study:

- To check whether the 5-Axis CNC machine is manufacturing components to the correct dimension/size or not.
- To evaluate whether our precision grinding process is operating strictly within the customer-provided engineering specifications.
- To perform Statistical Process Control (SPC) charting (X-bar & R chart) and assess Process Capability (Cp, Cpk) against aerospace benchmark thresholds (Cpk ≥ 1.33).

2. Sample Data Collection Table

Subgroup	Sample 1 (mm)	Sample 2 (mm)	Sample 3 (mm)	Sample 4 (mm)	Mean (X-bar) (mm)	Range (R) (mm)
SG-1	12.502	12.505	12.498	12.501	12.5015	0.007
SG-2	12.499	12.503	12.502	12.500	12.5010	0.004
SG-3	12.506	12.501	12.497	12.504	12.5020	0.009
SG-4	12.496	12.500	12.501	12.499	12.4995	0.003
SG-5	12.503	12.502	12.504	12.501	12.5025	0.003

3. Process Averages & Standard Deviation

1. Process Grand Mean (X-double-bar):

$$\bar{\bar{X}} = (12.5015 + 12.5010 + 12.5020 + 12.4995 + 12.5025) / 5 = 12.5013 \text{ mm}$$

2. Average Range (R-bar):

$$\bar{R} = (0.007 + 0.004 + 0.009 + 0.003 + 0.003) / 5 = 0.0052 \text{ mm}$$

3. Standard Constants (for subgroup size n = 4):

A2 = 0.729 | d2 = 2.059 | D3 = 0 | D4 = 2.282

4. Standard Deviation Estimation (σ):

$$\sigma = \bar{R} / d2 = 0.0052 / 2.059 = 0.00252 \text{ mm}$$

4. Process Capability Calculations (Cp & Cpk)

1. Process Capability Index (Cp):

$$Cp = (USL - LSL) / (6 \times \sigma) = (12.515 - 12.485) / (6 \times 0.00252) = 0.030 / 0.01512 = 1.98$$

2. Upper Capability Index (Cpu):

$$Cpu = (USL - \bar{\bar{X}}) / (3 \times \sigma) = (12.515 - 12.5013) / (3 \times 0.00252) = 0.0137 / 0.00756 = 1.81$$

3. Lower Capability Index (Cpl):

$$Cpl = (\bar{X} - LSL) / (3 \times \sigma) = (12.5013 - 12.485) / (3 \times 0.00252) = 0.0163 / 0.00756 = 2.15$$

4. Critical Capability Index (Cpk):

$$Cpk = \min(Cpu, Cpl) = \min(1.81, 2.15) = 1.81$$

Cp Index 1.98	Cpu Index 1.81	Cpl Index 2.15	Final Cpk 1.81
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5. Control Limits for X-bar & R Charts

A) X-bar Chart Control Limits:

- Center Line (CL): 12.5013 mm
- Upper Control Limit (UCL): $\bar{X} + (A2 \times \bar{R}) = 12.5013 + 0.00379 = 12.5052$ mm
- Lower Control Limit (LCL): $\bar{X} - (A2 \times \bar{R}) = 12.5013 - 0.00379 = 12.4975$ mm

B) R Chart (Range Chart) Control Limits:

- Center Line (CL): 0.0052 mm
- Upper Control Limit (UCL): $D4 \times \bar{R} = 2.282 \times 0.0052 = 0.0119$ mm
- Lower Control Limit (LCL): $D3 \times \bar{R} = 0 \times 0.0052 = 0$ mm

6. Final Observations & Engineering Conclusions

- Process Capability Status:** $Cpk = 1.81$ (> 1.33 benchmark). The CNC grinding process is **highly capable** of meeting aerospace quality standards.
- Process Centering:** Process Mean (12.5013 mm) is virtually centered on the target dimension (12.500 mm).
- Statistical Control Status:** **PROCESS IN STATISTICAL CONTROL.** All subgroup means and ranges remain within control limits with no out-of-control signals.